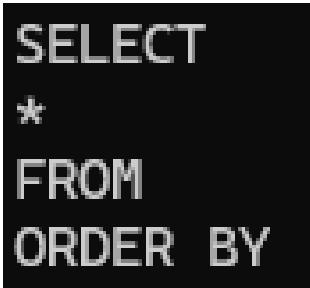


Querying Data in SQL Lab

Summary: This activity introduced me to the fundamentals of selecting and ordering data in SQL. I queried the organization's database to gather device details for updates and to review login activity for suspicious behavior. The goal of this lab was to get more comfortable using SQL to extract meaningful information that supports security analysis.

Commands Used:



```
SELECT
*
FROM
ORDER BY
```

Overview: I started by querying the machines table to retrieve all device information using `SELECT * FROM machines`. This returned every column in the table and provided a complete view of the organization's devices. The `SELECT` keyword specifies which data to return, the asterisk returns all the columns from a table, and `FROM` tells SQL which table to pull the data from. After that, I ran additional queries to focus on specific fields, such as device IDs, client emails, operating systems, and patch updates. To select specific columns instead of the entire table, I used a comma-separated list like `SELECT device_id, client_email FROM machines`. Selecting only the columns I needed made it easier to compare device configurations and identify systems that might require updates.

Next, I examined login activity stored in the `log_in_attempts` table. I retrieved fields like event IDs, usernames, login dates, and times to check for unusual behavior. To help my search for strange login attempts, I used the `ORDER BY` keyword to sort the data by date and time. Sorting the results made it easier to analyze the sequence of events and understand when each login occurred. Completing these tasks reinforced how SQL queries help organize and interpret data during security investigations.

Reflection: Working with SQL in this lab made it clearer how structured queries help analysts focus on the most relevant information. Selecting targeted columns and ordering results allowed me to quickly identify outdated devices and unusual login patterns. These skills form the foundation for more advanced database analysis.